

Topic: Micro-Operations

Q. What are Micro-Operations? Discuss the four main types: Register Transfer, Arithmetic, Logic, and Shift Micro-Operations with examples.

Definition to Remember

A **Micro-Operation** is the most basic, fundamental, atomic operation performed on data stored in CPU registers during one clock pulse. Every high-level machine instruction is broken down into a sequence of these elementary micro-operations.

1. Types of Micro-Operations

There are four primary categories of micro-operations based on their function.

A. Register Transfer Micro-Operations

Transfers data from one register to another without modifying the actual data.

* **Notation:** $\leftarrow$ indicates transfer.

* **Example:** $R2 \leftarrow R1$ (Copies data from R1 into R2. R1 is unchanged).

* **Control:** Usually triggered by a control condition: $\text{If } (P=1) \text{ then } R2 \leftarrow R1$.

B. Arithmetic Micro-Operations

Performs basic math on numeric data in registers.

* **Operations:** Add, Subtract, Increment, Decrement, 2's Complement (Negation).

* **Examples:**

* $R3 \leftarrow R1 + R2$ (Addition)

* $R1 \leftarrow R1 + 1$ (Increment)

* $R2 \leftarrow R1' + 1$ (2's Complement/Negate R1, store in R2).

C. Logic Micro-Operations

Performs bit-by-bit manipulation on non-numeric binary data.

* **Operations:** AND, OR, XOR, NOT.

* **Uses:** Masking bits, clearing registers, inserting bits.

* **Examples:**

* $R1 \leftarrow R1 \wedge R2$ (Bitwise XOR).

* $R1 \leftarrow R1 \& R2$ (Bitwise AND).

* $R1 \leftarrow 0$ (Can be done by XORing a register with itself: $R1 \leftarrow R1 \wedge R1$).

D. Shift Micro-Operations

Moves the binary bits of a register left or right. Used for data alignment and fast multiplication/division.

* **Logical Shift:** Shifts bits, filling the newly empty space with 0. ($R1 \leftarrow \text{shl } R1$).

* **Circular Shift (Rotate):** Bits shifted out of one end are fed directly back into the other end.

* **Arithmetic Shift:** Shifts right but preserves the Most Significant Bit (MSB/Sign bit), essential for signed negative numbers.

★ Must-Write Points (for 10 marks)

1. **Micro-Operation:** The smallest atomic operation executed in one clock pulse.
2. Four types: **Register Transfer, Arithmetic, Logic, Shift.**
3. **Register Transfer:** Moves data without changing it. Example: $R2 \leftarrow R1$.
4. **Arithmetic:** Basic math (Add, Sub, Inc). Example: $R3 \leftarrow R1 + R2$.
5. **Logic:** Bitwise operations (AND, OR, XOR) used for masking. Example: $R1 \leftarrow R1 \wedge R2$.
6. **Shift:** Moves bits left/right for alignment or fast math.
7. Shift types: Logical (fills with 0), Circular (rotates bits), Arithmetic (preserves sign bit).

⚡ Quick Recall

Micro-Ops (1 clock pulse) → 4 Types: Transfer ($R2 \leftarrow R1$) → Arithmetic ($R1 + R2$, +1) → Logic (AND/XOR, bit masking) → Shift (Logical, Circular, Arithmetic for signed math)